

Activity 5: Design a Total-Reward Job Offer Negotiation

TSC mapping: K1 | K2 | K3 | A1 | A3 Objective: Prepare a multi-issue employment offer negotiation using priorities, alternatives, evidence and ethical information boundaries. Expected output: Three authorised total-reward packages with rationale, limits and questions. Primary source: <https://sg.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/negotiation-skills>

Goal

Represent a growing technology SME hiring a regional operations manager where pay, flexibility, scope and start date have different value to each side.

Real-world scenario

Real-world use case: job offers are negotiated across salary, bonus, equity, flexibility, role scope, development and start date. Personal information must be handled lawfully and respectfully.

A Singapore software firm has selected a candidate for a regional operations role. The candidate's expected salary is above the original band, but they also value remote work, professional development and an earlier title review. The firm urgently needs a start within six weeks and must preserve internal equity.

Evidence boundary

The business setting is a realistic composite. Numerical and organisational inputs created for practice are labelled as training assumptions and must not be presented as real company facts.

Training assumptions / guardrails

- Approved base salary band is SGD 9,500-10,500 monthly.
- A sign-on award up to SGD 8,000 and training budget up to SGD 6,000 are available.
- The candidate's alternative offer is not verified and should not be treated as fact.
- The employer may offer two remote days weekly after a three-month onboarding period.

Questions

1. What are the employer's target, reservation point and non-financial priorities?
2. Which candidate interests should be tested rather than assumed?
3. How can three packages create choice while protecting internal equity?
4. Which candidate information is relevant, confidential or inappropriate to request?

Detailed activity procedure

Step 1: Confirm mandate

Document salary band, negotiable benefits, approval rules, internal-equity constraints and required start window.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 2: Prepare interest questions

Ask about role scope, career path, flexibility, start timing and risk-not personal circumstances unrelated to work.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 3: Review objective criteria

Use role level, skills scarcity, internal comparators and relevant market data with transparent limitations.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 4: Build packages

Create three combinations of base, sign-on award, development, flexibility, title review and start date.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 5: Set conditional trades

Link higher-cost terms to commitment, timing or performance conditions where fair and lawful.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 6: Prepare closure

Plan written confirmation, approval, expiry, reference checks and a respectful route if no agreement is reached.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Deliverable

Three authorised total-reward packages with rationale, limits and questions.

Acceptance criteria

All packages remain inside authority, address at least four issues, state objective criteria and avoid discriminatory or intrusive assumptions.

Reflection and debrief questions

1. Which assumption changed your negotiation plan most, and why?
2. What evidence would you request before relying on the result?
3. Which stakeholder owns the next decision or approval?
4. What would you repeat or change in the next negotiation?

Source note

Source accessed 15 August 2026: <https://sg.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/negotiation-skills>